

PulseFit — Rebuilding Motivation and Connection Inside VitaFit

From users quietly losing interest, to a gamified, community driven reason to come back.



They want to stay consistent. The app keeps giving them fewer reasons to.

Two root causes, one shared business outcome, lower repeat usage and weaker retention.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Health conscious VitaFit users who want to stay fit often lose motivation when they see **no visible progress**, get **no meaningful recognition**, and never build a **personal connection with instructors**.

The experience starts to feel **repetitive and transactional**, giving users fewer reasons to return, so they gradually break their routine.

STAGE 01 FADING MOTIVATION

High initial excitement fades fast once there is nothing new marking real progress or earning a reward.

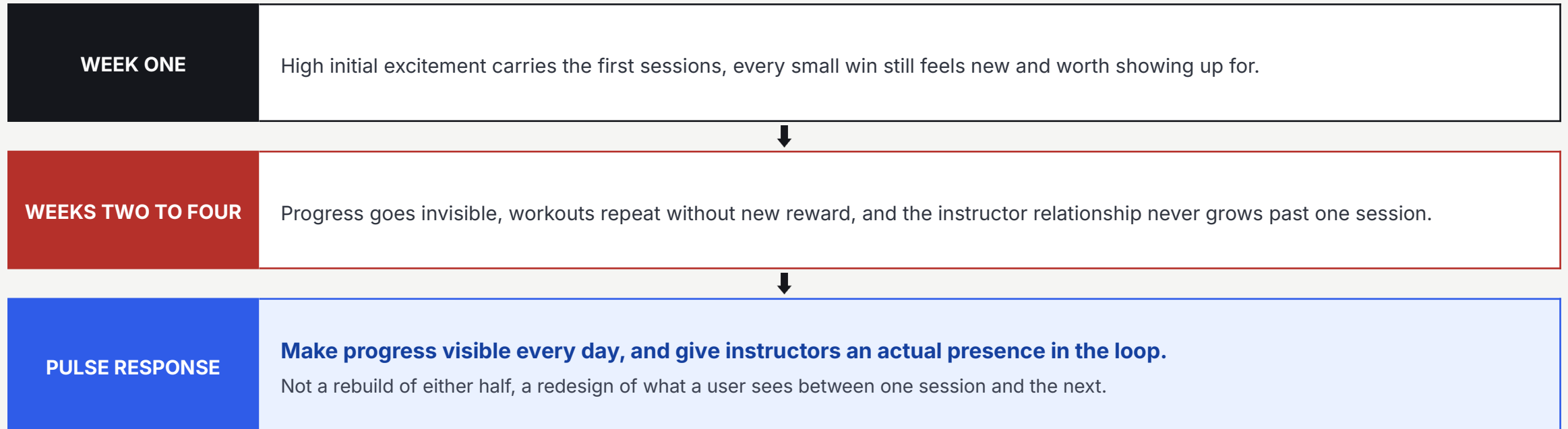


STAGE 02 DISTANT INSTRUCTORS

Sessions stay one sided, a user watches and logs off with no sense the instructor knows who they are.

The hardest moment is the one right before a user quietly stops opening the app.

User behavior follows a predictable arc after signup, and it points straight at the fix.



Three people, three different reasons to stay motivated

Pulse has to work for a busy professional, a retiree, and a student at once.

Uday

27 · Working Professional

Wants to stay fit despite a packed nine to five schedule. He needs targeted challenges, clear daily goals, and a regular nudge back into consistency, not an open ended plan he has to design himself.

Ramesh

60 · Retired Senior Citizen

Values social connection and belonging with people his own age. He treats fitness less as a target to hit and more as a reason to stay engaged with a community while keeping his independence.

Shikha

22 · College Student

Wants to lose weight and see a visibly healthier version of herself. She stays motivated by watching her avatar change as her real progress adds up, not by a number on a chart.

I wasn't adding features. I was building a reason to come back.

Pulse, a dedicated space inside VitaFit built around two features that work together.

VITAFIT TODAY

- Same session for every skill level
- No visible reward for showing up
- Instructors appear once, then disappear
- Progress lives only in the user's memory
- Nothing pulls users back after a missed day

VS

WITH PULSE

- Daily and weekly challenges sized to fitness level
- XP, a local leaderboard, and an avatar that evolves
- Instructors return as challenge leaders and unlock voices
- Progress visible every day, not just remembered
- Group challenges and events pull users back together

Every workout becomes visible, personal, and worth repeating

Four elements, each solving a specific piece of the motivation drop.

Element	What it does	Why it matters
Personalized challenges	Daily and weekly targets sized to fitness level, difficulty rising slowly as consistency holds.	Stays achievable for a beginner while still asking more each week.
Live GPS tracking	Tracks live location on the user's own neighbourhood map, with a nearby park suggestion mid route.	Turns a plain tracker into something that feels like actual guidance.
XP & local leaderboard	Every challenge earns XP, ranking users nearby by consistency rather than raw performance.	A beginner who shows up daily can genuinely outrank someone who skips days.
Evolving avatar	Resembles the user and visibly changes after every five kilograms of real weight loss.	An honest, visual marker that moves only when real progress happened.

This is also where the instructor connection gap gets addressed

Not a new instructor feature, a real place for them inside what users already return to.

Element	What it does	Why it matters
Share progress	Post a streak or milestone to a simple feed, friends and nearby users like or cheer it in one tap.	A reminder that a user is not the only one trying to keep this up.
Group challenges	Friends or neighbourhood users join the same challenge and track it together.	A shared stake is harder to quietly drop than a goal nobody else sees.
Local events	Nearby runs, yoga meetups, and community activities surface with a simple join option.	Extends the community past the screen, into something walkable.
Instructors as leaders	Instructors host and guide group challenges, and the Feature 1 biweekly unlock is framed as their personal tip.	The deliberate, honest fix for the instructor connection problem, addressed lightly, not ignored.

The four highest risk moments, translated into real screens

Pulse Home, Live Challenge, Rewards & Progress, Community, in the actual working prototype.

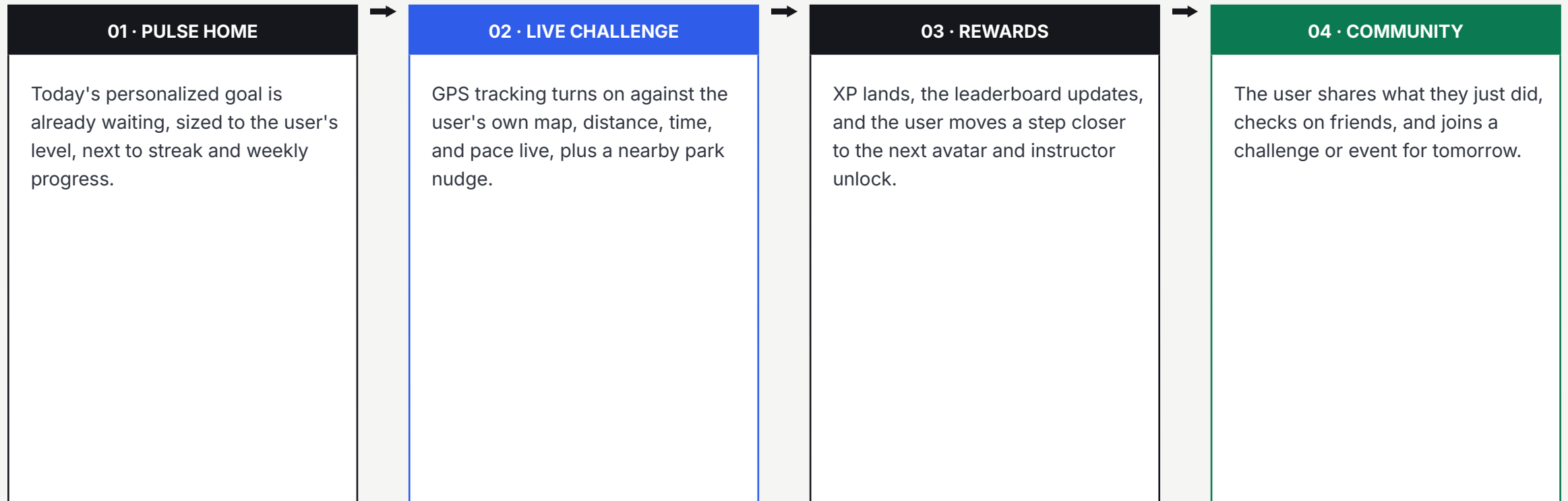
Segment	Definition	Research use
Non-exercisers	No regular workout habit	Onboarding, motivation triggers
Beginners (0-6 months)	Recently started exercising	First-time experience, early retention
Casual exercisers (1-2x/week)	Inconsistent workout habit	Habit formation, re-engagement
Regular exercisers (3-5x/week)	Established routine	Core feature usability, progression
Advanced/daily exercisers	Structured training programs	Data depth, customization, integrations

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Every screen removes friction from the next behaviour: open, start, finish, share.

One loop, across the four screens shown on the last slide

A user never has to decide what to do next, Pulse decides for them, every single time they open it.



Edge cases are handled too, weak GPS, a missed day, leaving mid challenge, each with its own fallback, so the loop never feels broken.

Four phases, each one proving itself before the next begins

The expensive parts, live GPS rendering and full avatar animation, are deliberately last.

01 // WEEKS 1-7

Core motivation loop

Onboarding, personalized challenges, the XP engine, the rewards screen, the minimum to test the loop.

02 // WEEKS 8-12

Social motivation

Community feed, group challenges, the local leaderboard, and local events layer on top of a proven loop.

03 // POST LAUNCH

Personalization & guidance

Long term progress, instructor framed unlocks, and milestone avatar evolution, once real usage data exists.

04 // POST LAUNCH

Expand the experience

Live GPS map rendering, real time avatar movement, and partner brand rewards, after adoption justifies it.

The scope was driven by what needed proving first, not by how many features could fit into v1.

I didn't want to measure whether Pulse got opened. I wanted to measure whether people kept coming back.

WEEKLY ACTIVE USERS

15 to 20% ↑

Overall engagement

SESSIONS PER WEEK

15% ↑

Habit formation

NORTH STAR METRIC

20% ↑

Repeat User Rate

vs. flat or declining repeat usage today

30 DAY RETENTION

10% ↑

Long term retention

COMMUNITY & INSTRUCTOR

25% ↑

Personal connection

Qualitative signal: in app feedback & NPS, tracked directionally, not targeted to a number.

Source: PulseFit PRD, Success Metrics section

■ SEE IT IN ACTION

Explore the working prototype

The PRD turned into something clickable, three places to judge it for yourself.

INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE

Click through the real screens, Pulse Home to Live Challenge to Community.

personal-pulse-quest.lovable.app

WIREFRAMES & FLOWS

The full Figma board behind this deck, every screen and state mapped out.

[View Figma board](#)

WALKTHROUGH VIDEO

A short recorded walkthrough of the prototype in motion.

[Watch on Drive](#)

FINAL PM TAKEAWAY

The problem was never that users forgot to work out.

It's that nothing in the app noticed when they did.